Home, my day & finding your way

Look → listen → cover → recall → write → type

Classroom material: 4 November 2026. Home, renting, routine, buildings and directions.

At home

家

Renting & getting around

坐 / 做 / 座

My day

先 → 再

Find your bearings

北 · 东 · 南 · 西

Around the campus

A 在 B 的……边

Give directions

往前走 · 左转 · 右转

Rain, money & similar sounds

钱 qián · 千 qiān · 前 qián

Original class sentences are retained; related examples are marked. Textbook maps are redrawn as teaching diagrams. Pinyin displays 一/不 tone changes in phrases; the syllable 边 is neutral here.

Where is the building?



Teaching diagram. North is always up. East is right. The front dormitory row is nearer the school.

银行在书店东边。
Yínháng zài shūdiàn dōngbian.

书店在银行西边。
Shūdiàn zài yínháng xībian.

宿舍楼都在北边。
Sùshè lóu dōu zài běibian.

Change your viewpoint

Left and right depend on which way you face. North and south do not change.

Facing north

东边 → 右边
dōngbian → yòubian

西边 → 左边
xībian → zuǒbian

北边 → 前边
běibian → qiánbian

南边 → 后边
nánbian → hòubian

Facing south

东边 → 左边
dōngbian → zuǒbian

西边 → 右边
xībian → yòubian

北边 → 后边
běibian → hòubian

南边 → 前边
nánbian → qiánbian

Memory cue: 东西 means east–west, but dōngxi also means “things”. The compass directions have a stable map reference; left/right use the person’s orientation.

A 在 B 的……边。

Name A, choose reference B, then add the direction. The 的 is often omitted: 银行在书店东边。

Read in meaning groups

我 有 一套公寓。

Wǒ yǒu yí tào gōngyù.

I have an apartment.

我的公寓里 有 两个卧室。

Wǒ de gōngyù lǐ yǒu liǎng ge wòshì.

There are two bedrooms in my apartment.

还有 一个厨房、 一个卫生间 和一个客厅。

Hái yǒu yí ge chúfáng, yí ge wèishēngjiān hé yí ge kètīng.

There is also a kitchen, a bathroom and a living room.

我的房间里 有 一张床、 一张桌子 和两把椅子。

Wǒ de fángjiān lǐ yǒu yì zhāng chuáng, yì zhāng zhuōzi hé liǎng bǎ yǐzi.

My room has a bed, a desk and two chairs.

你 想租房 吗?

Nǐ xiǎng zū fáng ma?

Do you want to rent a place?

Read in meaning groups

我 要租房， 不是租车。

Wǒ yào zū fáng, bú shì zū chē.

I want to rent a home, not a car.

我 想 坐出租车。

Wǒ xiǎng zuò chūzūchē.

I would like to take a taxi.

你 在干什么?

Nǐ zài gàn shénme?

What are you doing?

先考驾驶证， 再开车。

Xiān kǎo jiàshǐzhèng, zài kāi chē.

First get a driver’s licence, then drive.

我 六点半 起床。

Wǒ liù diǎn bàn qǐ chuáng.

I get up at 6:30.

Read in meaning groups

六点五十 吃早饭。

Liù diǎn wǔshí chī zǎofàn.

I eat breakfast at 6:50.

七点半 来学校。

Qī diǎn bàn lái xuéxiào.

I come to school at 7:30.

八点四十 上课。

Bā diǎn sìshí shàng kè.

Class starts at 8:40.

十二点 下课。

Shí'èr diǎn xià kè.

Class ends at noon.

十二点一刻 吃午饭。

Shí'èr diǎn yí kè chī wǔfàn.

I eat lunch at 12:15.

Read in meaning groups

下午 我也有课。

Xiàwǔ wǒ yě yǒu kè.

I also have class in the afternoon.

下课后 我 做作业。

Xià kè hòu wǒ zuò zuòyè.

After class, I do homework.

晚上六点 我 坐地铁 回家。

Wǎnshang liù diǎn wǒ zuò dìtiě huí jiā.

At 6 p.m. I take the metro home.

回家后 我 吃晚饭， 复习汉语。

Huí jiā hòu wǒ chī wǎnfàn, fùxí Hànyǔ.

After getting home, I have dinner and review Chinese.

我 大概晚上十一点 睡觉。

Wǒ dàgài wǎnshang shíyī diǎn shuì jiào.

I go to bed at about 11 p.m.

Read in meaning groups

请问， 银行 在哪儿?

Qǐngwèn, yínháng zài nǎr?

Excuse me, where is the bank?

银行 在 书店东边。

Yínháng zài shūdiàn dōngbian.

The bank is east of the bookshop.

这 是 什么地方?

Zhè shì shénme dìfang?

What place is this?

哪座楼 是 银行?

Nǎ zuò lóu shì yínháng?

Which building is the bank?

宿舍楼 都在 北边。

Sùshè lóu dōu zài běibian.

The dormitory buildings are all in the north.

Read in meaning groups

一号楼、二号楼 在前边， 三号楼、四号楼 在后边。

Yī hào lóu, èr hào lóu zài qiánbian, sān hào lóu, sì hào lóu zài hòubian.

Buildings 1 and 2 are in front; 3 and 4 are behind.

我的宿舍 在 四号楼。

Wǒ de sùshè zài sì hào lóu.

My dorm room is in Building 4.

一直 往前 走。

Yìzhí wǎng qián zǒu.

Go straight ahead.

到路口 往左 转。

Dào lùkǒu wǎng zuǒ zhuǎn.

At the intersection, turn left.

Related example

书店 在 银行西边。

Shūdiàn zài yínháng xībian.

The bookshop is west of the bank.

Related example

Read in meaning groups

今天 下雨， 我 用雨伞。

Jīntiān xià yǔ, wǒ yòng yǔsǎn.

It is raining today; I use an umbrella.

Related example

我 点了 外卖。

Wǒ diǎn le wàimài.

I ordered food delivery.

Related example

请 找我 十块钱。

Qǐng zhǎo wǒ shí kuài qián.

Please give me ten yuan in change.

Related example

你 很勇敢！

Nǐ hěn yǒnggǎn!

You are brave!

这 是 我们学校。

Zhè shì wǒmen xuéxiào.

This is our school.

Read in meaning groups

东边的 那座楼 是银行。

Dōngbian de nà zuò lóu shì yínháng.

That building on the east side is the bank.

不用。

Bú yòng.

No need.

你 在干嘛?

Nǐ zài gàn má?

What are you doing? (casual)

今天 天气 不好。

Jīntiān tiānqì bù hǎo.

The weather is bad today.

我 不用 出租车。

Wǒ bú yòng chūzūchē.

I do not need a taxi.

Words & connections

公寓	gōngyù	apartment
卧室	wòshì	bedroom
厨房	chúfáng	kitchen
卫生间	wèishēngjiān	bathroom
客厅	kètīng	living room
房间	fángjiān	room
床	chuáng	bed
桌子	zhuōzi	table; desk
椅子	yǐzi	chair
一套	yí tào	one set; classifier for an apartment
一张	yì zhāng	one flat object; classifier for a bed or desk
两把	liǎng bǎ	two; classifier for chairs or handled objects
租房	zū fáng	rent a home

Words & connections

租车	zū chē	rent a car
出租车	chūzūchē	taxi
坐	zuò	sit; take transport
做	zuò	do; make
座	zuò	classifier for buildings, mountains and bridges
驾驶证	jiàshǐzhèng	driver’s licence
开车	kāi chē	drive a car
起床	qǐ chuáng	get up
早饭	zǎofàn	breakfast
午饭	wǔfàn	lunch
晚饭	wǎnfàn	dinner
上课	shàng kè	attend class
下课	xià kè	finish class

Words & connections

做作业	zuò zuòyè	do homework
坐地铁	zuò dìtiě	take the metro
回家	huí jiā	return home
复习	fùxí	review; revise
睡觉	shuì jiào	sleep; go to bed
大概	dàgài	approximately; before the time expression
左右	zuǒyòu	about; after the time expression
东边	dōngbian	east; eastern side
西边	xībian	west; western side
南边	nánbian	south; southern side
北边	běibian	north; northern side
前边	qiánbian	in front; depends on the viewpoint
后边	hòubian	behind; depends on the viewpoint

Words & connections

左边	zuǒbian	left; depends on which way you face
右边	yòubian	right; depends on which way you face
银行	yínháng	bank
书店	shūdiàn	bookshop
学校	xuéxiào	school
宿舍	sùshè	dormitory
楼	lóu	building; storey
号	hào	number; label for a building
地方	dìfang	place
哪儿	nǎr	where
一座楼	yí zuò lóu	one building
一直	yìzhí	continuously; straight on in a route
往	wǎng	towards; in the direction of

Words & connections

走	zǒu	walk; go on foot
左转	zuǒ zhuǎn	turn left
右转	yòu zhuǎn	turn right
路口	lùkǒu	intersection
下雨	xià yǔ	rain; be raining
雨伞	yǔsǎn	umbrella
外卖	wàimài	takeaway; food delivery
钱	qián	money
千	qiān	thousand
找	zhǎo	look for; give change
用	yòng	use
勇敢	yǒnggǎn	brave
祈祷	qídǎo	pray

Hanzi + Pinyin by hand

One model, three attempts. Cover the model; write BOTH the Hanzi and tone-marked Pinyin.

公寓 gōngyù · apartment

公寓 gōngyù			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

卧室 wòshì · bedroom

卧室 wòshì			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

厨房 chúfáng · kitchen

厨房 chúfáng			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

卫生间 wèishēngjiān · bathroom

卫生间 wèishēngjiān			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

Hanzi + Pinyin by hand

One model, three attempts. Cover the model; write BOTH the Hanzi and tone-marked Pinyin.

房间 fángjiān · room

房间 fángjiān			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

出租车 chūzūchē · taxi

出租车 chūzūchē			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

租房 zū fáng · rent a home

租房 zū fáng			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

驾驶证 jiàshǐzhèng · driver's licence

驾驶证 jiàshǐzhèng			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

Hanzi + Pinyin by hand

One model, three attempts. Cover the model; write BOTH the Hanzi and tone-marked Pinyin.

做作业 zuò zuòyè · do homework

做作业 zuò zuòyè			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

坐地铁 zuò dìtiě · take the metro

坐地铁 zuò dìtiě			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

回家 huí jiā · return home

回家 huí jiā			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

睡觉 shuì jiào · sleep; go to bed

睡觉 shuì jiào			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

Hanzi + Pinyin by hand

One model, three attempts. Cover the model; write BOTH the Hanzi and tone-marked Pinyin.

东边 dōngbian · east; eastern side

Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory
东边 dōngbian			

西边 xībian · west; western side

Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory
西边 xībian			

南边 nánbian · south; southern side

Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory
南边 nánbian			

北边 běibian · north; northern side

Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory
北边 běibian			

Hanzi + Pinyin by hand

One model, three attempts. Cover the model; write BOTH the Hanzi and tone-marked Pinyin.

前边 qiánbian · in front; depends on the viewpoint

Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory
前边 qiánbian			

后边 hòubian · behind; depends on the viewpoint

Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory
后边 hòubian			

左边 zuǒbian · left; depends on which way you face

Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory
左边 zuǒbian			

右边 yòubian · right; depends on which way you face

Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory
右边 yòubian			

Hanzi + Pinyin by hand

One model, three attempts. Cover the model; write BOTH the Hanzi and tone-marked Pinyin.

银行 yínháng · bank

Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory
银行 yínháng			

书店 shūdiàn · bookshop

Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory
书店 shūdiàn			

学校 xuéxiào · school

Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory
学校 xuéxiào			

宿舍 sùshè · dormitory

Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory
宿舍 sùshè			

Hanzi + Pinyin by hand

One model, three attempts. Cover the model; write BOTH the Hanzi and tone-marked Pinyin.

一直 yìzhí · continuously; straight on in a route

一直 yìzhí			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

左转 zuǒ zhuǎn · turn left

左转 zuǒ zhuǎn			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

钱 qián · money

钱 qián			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

千 qiān · thousand

千 qiān			
Model / trace	From memory	From memory	From memory

Try without the model / 1



1. 银行在书店的哪边?
2. 书店在银行的哪边?
3. 一号楼在书店的哪边?
4. 书店在一号楼的哪边?
5. 四号楼在三号楼的哪边?
6. 三号楼在四号楼的哪边?
7. 四号楼在二号楼的哪边?
8. 二号楼在四号楼的哪边?

Try without the model / 2

Use your Chinese keyboard. Type the Pinyin letters without tone marks, then select the intended Hanzi candidate.

1. zuo · 我……地铁。
坐 / 做 / 座

2. zuo · 我……作业。
坐 / 做 / 座

3. zuo · 一……楼。
坐 / 做 / 座

4. qian · 请找我十块……。
钱 / 千 / 前

5. fang · ……间
方 / 房 / **放**

6. shi · 卧……
试 / 室 / **事**

7. ke · 上……
课 / 客 / **可**

8. zhao · 我……书店。
找 / 我 / **戏**

Try without the model / 3

Write the missing system: Hanzi → Pinyin with tones; Pinyin → Hanzi.

东边

银行

厨房

坐地铁

qián

qiān

xuéxiào

yǔsǎn

Speak, then check

银行在哪儿？你的宿舍在哪座楼？你几点起床？

Check after your attempt

Where is the building?

1. 东边 dōngbian
2. 西边 xībian
3. 北边 běibian
4. 南边 nánbian
5. 东边 dōngbian
6. 西边 xībian
7. 北边 běibian
8. 南边 nánbian

IME

1 坐 · 2 做 · 3 座 · 4 钱 · 5 房 · 6 室 · 7 课 · 8 找

Hanzi / Pinyin with tones

dōngbian · yínháng · chúfáng · zuò dìtiě

钱 · 千 · 学校 · 雨伞